

2027 General Operations Food Storage & Distribution Hub

The House of Manna, Inc. • Management planning estimate • October 6, 2026

House of Manna seeks 2027 general operating support to establish a Baltimore food storage and distribution hub. A modest leased warehouse will provide truck and pallet access, organized dry storage, commercial refrigeration and freezer capacity, and a volunteer packing area. This capacity will help House of Manna receive larger food donations and prepare distributions for multiple communities beyond its initial church-based location. The first-year hub funding goal is \$76,060, including \$46,860 for annual operations, \$17,050 for equipment and setup, a \$1,500 refundable deposit, and \$10,650 in operating reserves. The plan is contingent on funding and a suitable approved facility; the lease and expanded service locations have not yet been secured.

Funding component	2027 amount
Annual hub operating envelope	\$46,860
Setup funding envelope	\$17,050
Refundable lease deposit (held asset)	\$1,500
Three-month reserve (base recurring costs)	\$10,650
Total first-year hub funding goal	\$76,060

What the space enables

A proposed 500–1,000 sq. ft. private unit with shared or dedicated dock access, approved commercial food storage, reliable power, suitable sanitation access, dry shelving, cold-storage equipment and packing space. Size is a working search criterion, not a statement that this size is available at the proposed rent. Pallets of shelf-stable goods can be staged and unpacked. Perishable deliveries must fit the usable refrigerator/freezer capacity and be promptly transferred from temperature-controlled transport.

This is a distribution hub, not a public walk-in pantry or commercial kitchen. Initial community distributions remain coordinated through the church and, as capacity develops, additional community sites. Proposed locations and delivery partnerships will be confirmed before launch. Reach-in appliances cannot store intact refrigerated pallets; a walk-in cooler/freezer would require separate pricing and facility approval.

1. Full-year recurring hub operations

Cost	Annual	Basis / purpose
Warehouse lease	\$15,000	12 months × \$1,250; user planning range \$1,000–\$1,500. No lease or quote secured.
Incremental refrigeration power / occupancy charges	\$1,800	12 × \$150 allowance; remove charges already covered by rent. Continuous refrigeration requires landlord approval.
Insurance	\$2,400	12 × \$200 allowance for liability, contents, food spoilage and applicable transport coverage; obtain broker quote.
Cleaning, pest control and waste	\$1,800	12 × \$150 incremental allowance; confirm landlord services before spending.
Equipment service and repairs	\$1,200	12 × \$100 allowance for cold-storage maintenance; replacement beyond allowance uses contingency.
Food pickup and delivery logistics	\$6,000	12 × \$500 for rentals or hired transport, fuel, tolls and required coverage. No vehicle purchase; refrigerated transport priced separately if needed.
Warehouse packing and safety supplies	\$2,400	12 × \$200 for cartons, food-safe containers, labels, PPE and cleaning supplies; warehouse-specific, separate from education materials.
Part-time operations coordination	\$12,000	Approx. 8 hours/week × \$25 × 52 = \$10,400 plus \$1,600 payroll burden allowance. Employee cost assumption; confirm payroll and workers' compensation quotes.
Recurring subtotal	\$42,600	Average \$3,550/month before contingency
Operating contingency	\$4,260	10% of recurring subtotal; use only if funder permits
Annual operating envelope	\$46,860	Average \$3,905/month including contingency

All costs are management allowances unless specifically identified as reference retail prices. Rent does not imply utilities, food-storage permission or refrigeration power have been verified for a particular unit. No full-time executive salary is included. Volunteers supplement paid coordination, not a guaranteed supply of labor.

2. Equipment, setup and working capital

Setup item	Amount	Basis / purpose
Commercial refrigerators and freezers	\$8,000	Two double-door refrigerators and two double-door freezers: reference retail total \$7,456; \$544 allowance for delivery/tax/price variance. Planning specification, not a selected vendor.
Dry storage shelving and worktables	\$2,000	Food-safe storage and sorting surfaces; racking loads and layout to be confirmed.
Handling equipment	\$1,000	Dollies, carts and pallet jack allowance; reduce if shared equipment is sufficient.
Electrical assessment and minor installation	\$2,000	Confirm dedicated circuits, equipment loads, outlets, ventilation and landlord permission. No major build-out included.
Temperature monitoring	\$500	Thermometers, data logs and alert sensors; recurring fees, if any, fit administration budget.
Insulated transport containers	\$750	Coolers and cold packs for short trips; not a substitute for a refrigerated truck on long routes.
Move-in, locks and basic signage	\$750	Moving and warehouse security setup; no duplicate ongoing security charge.
Training, inspections and permits allowance	\$500	Food handling and facility review allowance; actual required approvals and fees must be confirmed.
Setup subtotal	\$15,500	One-time purchases and readiness costs
Setup contingency	\$1,550	10% allowance
Setup funding envelope	\$17,050	Equipment and readiness total

Cash needs that are not operating expenses

Refundable deposit: \$1,500, held as a recoverable asset subject to the lease. Operating reserve: \$10,650, equal to three months of the \$3,550 base recurring costs. The reserve is a cash buffer, not another three months of expense and not a second charge for the same cost. Seek unrestricted funding for reserve/deposit unless explicitly permitted by the grant. Major renovations, a walk-in cold room, a truck purchase, forklift, generator and property acquisition are excluded and would require new quotes.

3. Organization-wide 2027 planning reconciliation

The October 5 Straus planning document carried a \$55,000 operating plan plus an \$8,000 lab technology package. This revised management proposal adds the hub as incremental expansion capacity; it is not board-approved or an audited financial statement. Previous applications and existing website project campaign goals are not rewritten by this proposal.

Existing planning category	2027 amount
Food and essential-needs assistance	\$15,000
Youth entrepreneurship and financial education	\$12,000
Student participation support and incentives	\$6,000
Educational materials and program supplies	\$5,000
Community outreach and recruitment	\$4,000
Program administration, evaluation and reporting	\$8,000
Community events and program delivery	\$5,000
Innovation Lab technology package	\$8,000
Existing plan subtotal	\$63,000
Incremental hub expenditure envelope	\$63,910
Combined 2027 expenditure envelope	\$126,910
Hub deposit and reserve (cash assets)	\$12,150
Combined 2027 funding requirement	\$139,060

Avoid duplication: existing administration covers organization-wide bookkeeping, governance and reporting; hub coordination covers receiving, inventory and routing. Existing program/event budgets cover participant services and event delivery; warehouse packing and transport lines cover incremental hub operations. Before submitting a detailed application, map each invoice or role to one cost center and reduce any overlapping allowance. No existing campaign goal or pending request is automatically additional expenditure. The church facility repair campaign is excluded from this consolidated plan; already funded refrigeration should reduce new equipment costs if usable at the hub.

No award is allocated to this new 2027 hub plan without confirming its permitted use and award period. This document does not restate current organizational cash or grant wins. Donated food, gift cards and volunteer time are reported separately from cash funding and do not pay rent. Equipment may be capitalized and depreciated under the organization's accounting policy; the expenditure envelope is a fundraising cash plan, not a GAAP income statement.

4. Delivery, evidence and sustainability

Q1 2027, contingent on funding: compare spaces, obtain insurance and equipment quotes, verify required food-facility approvals with the relevant Baltimore/Maryland authorities, approve the lease and install equipment. Q2: test receiving, temperature logs, inventory rotation and delivery routes; begin additional community distributions. Q3–Q4: expand only where donations, staffing, transport and community relationships support reliable service.

Proposed first-year targets, subject to readiness: 18 distribution cycles from April–December, serving at least three distinct community locations; an initial capacity target of two receiving appointments per month after opening, with pallet quantities capped by actual storage capacity. These are planning targets, not historical results or confirmed partnerships. Track pounds received and distributed, unique households and repeat visits separately, site coverage, temperature checks, rejected/spoiled food, volunteer hours and cost per distribution. Set household and pound targets after establishing supplier capacity and a baseline.

Require documented receipt and temperature checks, first-expiring-first-out rotation, traceable donor/inventory records and an outage response with a cold-storage transfer plan. Confirm electrical load, overnight power, permitted food use, loading hours, vehicle access, sanitation and staffing before committing to a lease. Secure setup/deposit plus at least six months of base operating coverage (\$21,300), with the reserve held separately, and a credible plan for the balance before opening.

Continuation funding will be sought from foundation operating grants, recurring individual gifts, workplace giving and corporate sponsorships. A proposed \$1,250 monthly space sponsorship covers base rent only. Review cash coverage monthly; reduce receiving/delivery frequency or delay expansion if funding is insufficient. No future income is represented as committed.

Grant asks that fit different funders

Operating-only ask: up to \$46,860 for 12-month hub operations; omit contingency if ineligible. Equipment/setup ask: \$17,050, adjusted for eligible categories. First-year unrestricted hub ask: \$76,060 including deposit/reserve where allowed. A \$25,000 operating grant could cover \$15,000 rent, \$2,400 insurance, \$1,800 incremental occupancy costs and \$5,800 of pickup/delivery logistics. The remaining goal would be sought from other donors without billing the same costs twice.

5. Sensitivity, sources and submission notes

Rent/month	Annual operations*	Hub funding goal*
\$1,000	\$43,560	\$71,710
\$1,250	\$46,860	\$76,060
\$1,500	\$50,160	\$80,410

*Rent-only sensitivity. Deposit modeled at 1.2 months of rent; reserve at three months of base costs. Other costs held constant. Fully volunteer coordination would reduce the base-case goal by \$16,200 (\$12,000 pay allowance, \$1,200 contingency, \$3,000 reserve), but only if dependable volunteer coverage is established. Major electrical work or refrigerated transport could raise the budget materially.

Planning sources checked October 6, 2026

User-provided rent range and prior WareWorks experience. WareWorks official amenities: ware-works.com — loading docks, shared pallet jacks, Wi-Fi and utilities advertised; no unit price, continuous refrigeration permission or power capacity confirmed.

Reference commercial equipment prices: WebstaurantStore Avantco A-49R-HC double-door refrigerator \$1,839 and A-49F-HC double-door freezer \$1,889 (two each = \$7,456). Retail references are sizing/pricing anchors, not procurement recommendations or binding quotes. Confirm tax status, shipping, warranty and installation.

<https://www.webstaurantstore.com/avantco-a-49r-hc-54-solid-door-reach-in-refrigerator/178A49RHC.html>
<https://www.webstaurantstore.com/avantco-a-49f-hc-54-solid-door-reach-in-freezer/178A49FHC.html>

Internal source: House_of_Manna_Straus_First_Year_Planning_Budget.pdf, October 5, 2026. Proposed 2027 hub assumptions and allocations developed October 6, 2026. Replace estimates with quotes and confirm board adoption before marking this as an approved annual organizational budget.

Paste-ready general operating request

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